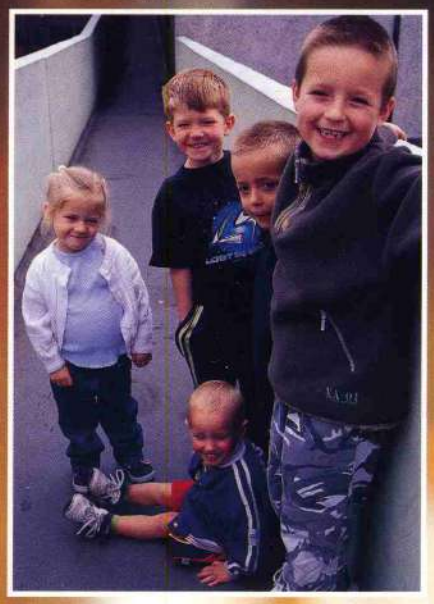
Gallions
Housing Association



building a brighter tomorrow, today

annual review 2003-4

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION


GALLIONS
HOUSING
ASSOCIATION

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It's been a fantastic year for Gallions. We've become a member of the National Housing Federation's 'iN Business for Neighbourhoods' scheme and we've won a range of awards for our community and housing projects. Here are some of the highlights of which we are really proud



through the looking glass

The Daily Telegraph WHAT HOUSE? AWARDS 2003 WINNER

Best energy saving development, What House? Awards 2003

Awarded by the *Daily Telegraph* for Gallions' Ecopark, our sustainable housing development in Thamesmead.

the civic trust

Commendation Awards, Civic Trust Awards 2004

Awarded to Ecopark by the Civic Trust for outstanding architecture and environmental design.

NATIONAL HOUSING FEDERATION

Achievement in Diversity Award 2004

Awarded by the National Housing Federation for Gallions' Affordable Home Ownership Scheme at Priory Place. The award recognised Gallions' efforts in ensuring a mixed tenure that reflected Thamesmead's varied cultures.

Office of the Deputy Prime Minister
Creating sustainable communities

Achievement in Innovation Award 2004

Awarded by the Office of the Deputy Prime Minister to Gallions' Neighbourhood Wardens for a children's remote control car club.

LONDON excellence

Commitment to Excellence Award 2004

Awarded to Gallions by London Excellence, part of the British Quality Foundation, for continuing improvement using the principles of excellence.

QHS Quality Housing Services Ltd

Quality Housing Services (QHS) is an independent standard that tests housing associations up and down the country on the quality of their customer services. Gallions is an inaugural member and is one of the first four associations to undergo a trial inspection which we passed with flying colours.

GAiN

In early 2004, Gallions and Presentation formed GAiN, an alliance of medium housing associations in the Thames Gateway. GAiN will encourage successful neighbourhoods through a wider range of social services and social investment initiatives.

iN

iN Business for Neighbourhoods

Gallions was proud to become a member of 'iN Business for Neighbourhoods', the national alliance of housing associations committed to creating good neighbourhoods in towns and cities in England.

THE HOUSING CORPORATION

Four green lights!

We were thrilled to receive four green lights in our Housing Corporation assessment in March 2004.

chair's statement



"I was appointed Chair of Gallions Housing Association in September 2003 and it has been a privilege to serve the organisation since then. I took over from Graham Horton who had worked tirelessly for Gallions and I wish to record a debt of gratitude to him."

These are exciting and indeed challenging times for Gallions Housing Association. The Thames Gateway is undergoing a major change. The Government's Sustainable Communities Plan projects housing growth at 200,000 homes in the South East and jobs growth of 250,000. The regeneration proposals include implementation of major transport projects with the Thames Gateway Bridge, the Channel Tunnel rail link and, hopefully, Crossrail all coming in between 2007 and 2013.

Gallions Housing Association is based in the Thames Gateway with the major stockholding in Greenwich and Bexley. The organisation has sound financial footings and has a significant capacity to develop more homes. Gallions wishes to be at the forefront of this development programme. We are ideally placed not simply because of our finance or our location but importantly also because of our performance. The association has received flying colours on all its regulatory reports and its development delivery has been praised by the Housing Corporation. This was acknowledged by the new Chairman of the Housing Corporation, Peter Dixon, at an event held in the House of Commons to mark our work. These are all solid foundations on which to build our regeneration aspirations.

The quality of our development is self-evident. Our widely renowned Ecopark development has received several awards. A number of high profile visitors have seen the evidence of our work – these include the Deputy Prime Minister, John Prescott, and Sir John Egan.

We are very mindful that our development aspirations must not be at the cost of good housing management. We are continuing to excel in this and our tenants' satisfaction rating remains very high. Our tenants are very happy with our neighbourhood management concept which includes Community Wardens and community policing via our links with the Metropolitan Police. The bedrock of a good development is good housing management – we are proud of our track record and we will always strive to improve our performance even further.

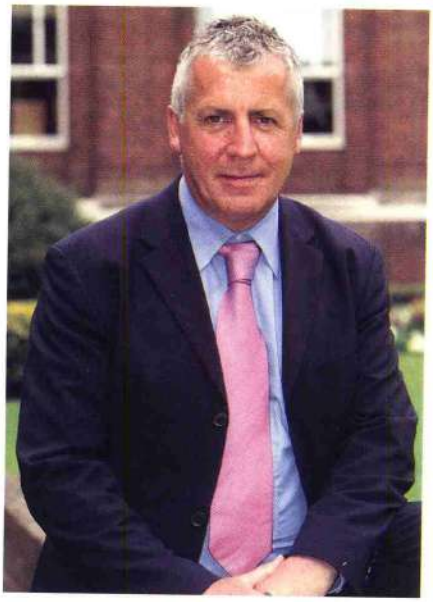
Gallions is very lucky to have an excellent Executive Team and solid staffing complement. I thank all our employees for their hard work and commitment. Equally I also thank all the Board members, not only for their support to me but also for the valuable time they have given Gallions Housing Association.

Gallions Housing Association's future is bright. The organisation is dynamic and innovative. We are recognised by regulators as an excellent performer. Gallions is strategically well placed in the Thames Gateway – with our partners we hope to be leading the regeneration proposals.

I commend this annual report to you.

Aman Dalvi
Chair

chief executive's statement



"Since our creation in June 2000 we have been working hard to improve services for our customers and ensure our activities and interests are central to the needs of the community we work in. Nearly four years on we have begun to extend the range and scope of services and products we offer to help create and maintain a sustainable community in Thamesmead."

Nearly every aspect of our activities involves partnership with other agencies and organisations. This is because no single organisation has the solutions or resources to meet the complex and multiple needs of our community. Working with others has helped us bring increased investment to the Thamesmead community. Whether we lead or support is not as important to us as securing additional investment. Everywhere you look in Thamesmead there is the evidence of this success and much of this is reflected on the pages of this annual report. In this regard we see our role as advocates for our community and we also see ourselves as part of the community.

There is also evidence that we are beginning to earn trust and respect for what we do. We still have much more to do to maintain this let alone extend it. Nevertheless, there is growing recognition in the form of an increasing number of awards, for instance the multi award winning Ecopark, the Low Cost Home Ownership Award for diversity and an award for our Neighbourhood Wardens. However, by far the most important recognition is the strength of our relationship with our residents and customers. This too is improving. Residents are directly represented on our main Board and the Gallions Residents Board is playing an increasing role in helping to improve our services. Here too there is more that we can do and are planning to improve, but it is encouraging that during the year, a joint study by the Audit Commission and the Housing Corporation cited Gallions as an example of good practice in terms of resident involvement in governance.

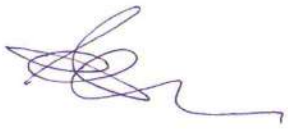
Many housing associations claim to be able to provide neighbourhood services to create sustainable communities. Some see opportunities to do this in the Thames Gateway. We are fortunate that Thamesmead provides us with an opportunity to demonstrate our capabilities in both regards. Sustainable Communities cannot be created overnight and our investment in Thamesmead demonstrates our continuing commitment to the long term of the communities we work with.

Our activities fit very well with the National Housing Federation's campaign for Housing Associations, 'iN Business for Neighbourhoods'. We are proud to be early adoptors of this programme, the key messages of which are as follows:

- We are in business for neighbourhoods
- We put our energy into creating places where people want to live
- We invest in a range of services as well as homes
- We are an independent social business working with local people and partner organisations to deliver results

These statements reflect and fit very well with our approach and commitment.

I am extremely grateful for the clear guidance from our Board, the hard work of my colleagues and the support we have enjoyed from all our partners over the last year.



Tony Cotter
Chief Executive

We aim to increase the provision of homes, services and products in existing and new areas for a wide-ranging client group



key objectives



Objective 1

To have in place robust governance that enables the delivery of a comprehensive set of strategies for the proper running of the business.

Objective 2

To adopt a financial and investment strategy based on a careful assessment of risk, to ensure our long-term financial viability.

Objective 3

To provide or facilitate the provision of a range of high quality services that are good value to customers and where possible offer choice.

Objective 4

To effectively manage our assets to provide good quality, decent homes for existing and future residents.

Objective 5

To invest in creating sustainable neighbourhoods in the Thames Gateway and use Thamesmead as a showcase of our success.

Objective 6

To increase the provision of homes, services and products in existing and new areas for a wide-ranging client group.

Objective 7

To establish our position in the sector as an innovative and customer focused organisation.

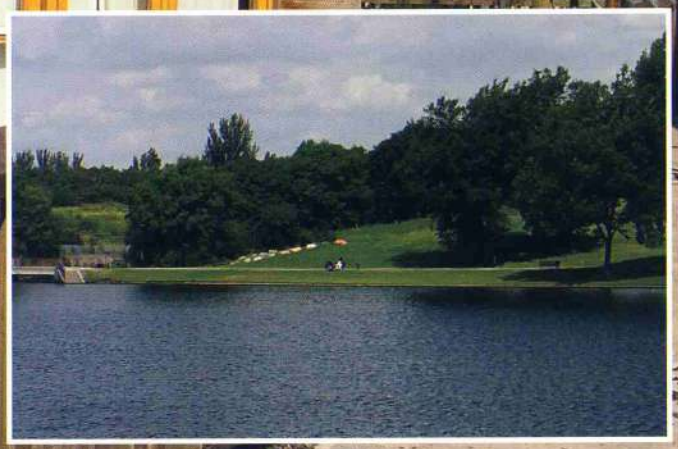
Objective 8

To maximise opportunities for sustaining and protecting the environment.

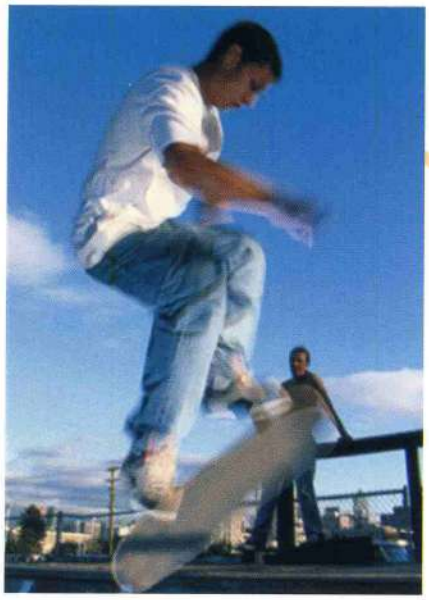
Objective 9

To improve community safety, working in partnership with other key agencies.

The Communities Plan is already making a difference to life in the Thames Gateway



living the dream



The Sustainable Communities Plan is well under way, with the Thames Gateway topping the agenda. Gallions is well placed to open up the Gateway with fresh developments that will allow the area to shine.

The perfect match

Since Gallions was established in 2000, we've been delivering what our tenants want most – high quality customer service, improved community safety, and a clean and attractive environment. We were thrilled when John Prescott launched the Sustainable Communities Plan because it fitted in so well with our own work.

The Communities Plan is already making a difference to life in the Thames Gateway. Funding has been set aside for business parks and ecological and educational improvements, with the new Bexley Business Academy already open in Thamesmead. The financial commitment to transport links that followed the Plan also means the area will be opened up to employment opportunities just across the river in Docklands, and in Europe.

The ODPM has also committed £10 million to Gallions' regeneration of Tavy Bridge, part of the original Thamesmead. Delivered in partnership with Wates Construction Ltd, this £120 million project will introduce 555 new homes for open market sale as well as increasing the amount of affordable housing in Thamesmead. The Thamesmead community remains at the heart of our business, but we're also looking to grow outside the area and further into the Thames Gateway, both north and south of the river.

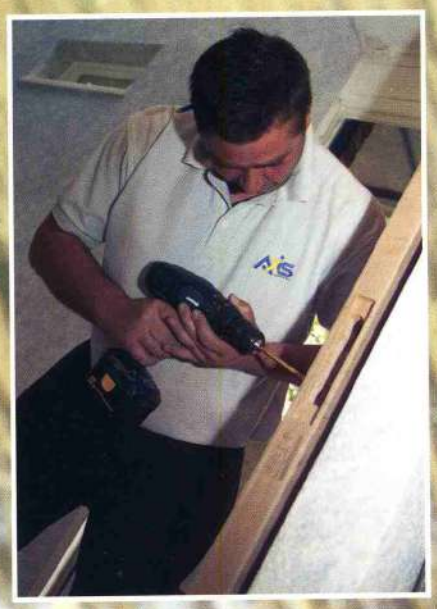
Right place, right time!

Thamesmead's position in the heart of the Thames Gateway gives Gallions a golden opportunity to grow. Our ownership of Thamesmead's lakes, canals and parks is unusual and gives us opportunities that other housing associations don't have.

Our Team Gallions environmental service has already developed into a successful environmental management service. Working with our neighbourhood wardens, these combined teams have provided an increased patrolling presence in Thamesmead that has almost totally eradicated vehicle arson and graffiti, and has engaged young people in activities that divert them from crime.

Growing up

Our plans for growth now include the regeneration of areas outside Thamesmead with new build, stock transfers and acquisitions. Our commitment to partnerships is vital to these plans and will help us build Gallions' reputation as an excellent neighbourhood manager.



We learned early that working in partnership with other people is good for the community and runs through all our work

it's about the team



Strong partnerships are key to our success. With their assistance, we're turning the Gateway vision into reality.

Making partnerships

We learned early that working in partnership with other people is good for the community and this principle runs through all our work. We are keen to build both community and business partnerships to create successful neighbourhoods in Thamesmead and beyond.

Development partnerships

Development partnerships are at the core of our business. Over this year we have continued to build on our successful relationship with Barratt Homes and with their help, we have not only delivered new affordable homes for rent but have moved into the intermediate market.

We have sold 72 shared ownership homes and have acquired more homes to utilise slippage on the ADP and Starter Home Initiative programmes through a bulk purchase deal with Barratt. We also work closely with a range of other developers including Colonnade Residential, Persimmon, Fairclough and Wates Construction. A small number of specialist consultants also provide Gallions with excellent support. These include Broadway Malyan, EC Harris, Frankham, Calford Seaden and CS Trimmer.

Working with the government

On the government front, we've cemented good relations with the Housing Corporation and were pleased to receive our first green light from them for our development work. ODPM funding of £10 million for the Tavy Bridge regeneration project has also opened up another exciting partnership.

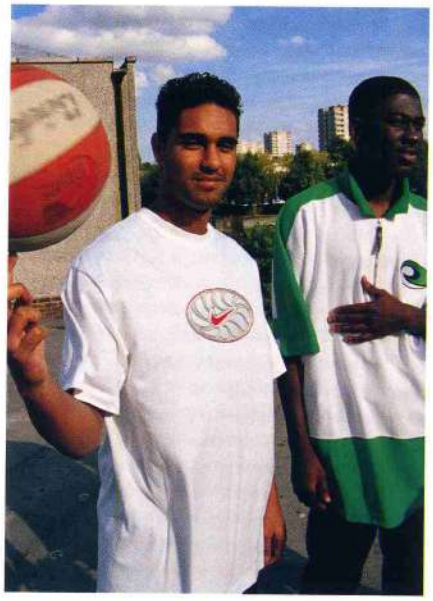
Local authority assistance

We've always worked closely with Bexley and Greenwich Councils when planning developments. Gallions' new build Extra Care Sheltered scheme for Thamesmead, planned to start in 2004/5, would not have been possible without council member support. Additionally, both councils have been fundamental in getting the Tavy Bridge project off the ground.

Our Community Investment Team continues to build partnerships that contribute to the safety and well being of people living in Thamesmead



lasting partnerships



Making partnerships that last is important to us. By growing together, we're giving our tenants value for money and an unbeatable service.

Environmental partnerships

Keeping the environment in Thamesmead clean and tidy is an enormous job. Team Gallions has worked hard to develop relationships that not only complement their own expertise, but also add fresh and innovative ideas to one of the most important areas of Gallions' work in Thamesmead.

Over the year, they have worked with the following organisations:

- *Greenwich and Bexley Councils and the police on CUBIT operations to remove untaxed vehicles from streets and parking bays*
- *The London Borough of Greenwich, on the continuing CleanSweep project, which recognises the responsibilities of both organisations for managing the environment in Thamesmead*
- *Greenwich and Bexley Councils, on a new initiative to extend recycling household rubbish facilities for residents in flats*
- *Thamesmead Fishing Club, providing staff and vehicle back-up on work days removing rubbish from canals and lakes*
- *The Southmere Boating Centre, providing straw bales which are used to control algae growth in the lake*
- *Local schools, developing work for the national curriculum under the category 'Improving the Environment'*
- *Local elderly residents, helping them to improve their communal gardens and balcony space with labour and materials*
- *Bromley Field Studies Centre, giving work experience to the unemployed, and opportunities for permanent employment within Gallions*
- *Thamesmead Youth Awareness Project, running a rap music competition aimed at getting environmental messages across to young people*
- *The Prince's Trust, encouraging young volunteers to plant communal gardens for elderly residents*
- *Tilfen Land, developing a joint composting operation for green waste in a secure location.*

Community partnerships

Our Community Investment Team continues to build partnerships that contribute to the safety and well being of people living in Thamesmead. Through their work with the local police and a range of other important community groups, they are keeping crime levels down and creating a community where people feel safe.

This year the team has worked closely with Greenwich and Bexley Councils, Age Concern and the Department of Work and Pensions to improve services for older, vulnerable people in Thamesmead. They have also encouraged young people to take up positive activities with the help of local schools, the police, social services, local youth awareness projects and Gallions' own neighbourhood wardens.


By
building on the
past, we're changing
the face of Thamesmead

developing the gateway



We're changing the face of Thamesmead and creating a successful and sustainable community in the Thames Gateway.

What the Tavy Bridge project means to me

"The Tavy Bridge regeneration will have a great impact on my family. As residents of Binsey Walk we will have better quality housing and a safer environment to bring our children up in. By removing the horrible underground car park, crime will stop being allowed to breed. I can see that the new plans will give us better access and better parking facilities. This means I won't have to struggle halfway along Binsey Walk with my shopping anymore because at the moment I'm unable to park near my property because I'm scared that my car will be vandalised. I'm really excited and can't wait for Gallions to begin work."

Sarah Meagher, Tavy Bridge Resident

New developments

Gallions' new build developments have continued to grow this year. As the first of the five-year projects in our business plan, it was important to identify schemes for the coming years alongside delivering existing projects. Both of these aims proved successful, and the year ended with congratulations from our regulator for the successful delivery of our development programme.

We have completed a number of schemes this year including:

- **Priory Place**

Situated close to Gallions' offices, this 200 unit scheme originally included 40 shared ownership and affordable rented flats as part of a bigger scheme being developed by Barratt. Government funding meant we were able to purchase a further 45 units which we sold to key workers. The success of this scheme released further funding for extra units at Thames Walk, a new development in Thamesmead.

- **Collingtree Park**

Located near Thamesmead town centre, Collingtree Park is a development of 70 units, all for affordable rent, including high quality flats and houses. Delivered as part of a planning obligation, the units were popular among nominees from both the London Borough of Greenwich's waiting list and our own. The scheme was partly funded using a Housing Corporation subsidy of approximately £6 million.

- **Paradise Path**

Also close to the town centre, this scheme was Gallions' first move into shared ownership sales. In the early part of the year, six units were sold to people in specific areas of need with a further 13 houses built and let to tenants at an affordable rent.

The future

The future's bright. We've already begun work on over 220 units of mixed types and tenures in the Gallions' Reach Urban Village where 62 homes have been built. Work has also started on 30 mixed units at Waterside Mews and a further four at The Reach. Many other schemes such as Tripcock Point, are in the early stages of design with work scheduled to begin on the first 100 homes in 2004/5. Developed in partnership with Tilfen Land, Tripcock Point will eventually include 600 Gallions' affordable homes.

Tavy Bridge facelift

The regeneration of Tavy Bridge is about to start. After a year's worth of consultation with residents and agencies including Bexley Council, the Environment Agency and the Greater London Authority, the Tavy Bridge Project Team is now able to submit outline plans for the regeneration of the area for approval.

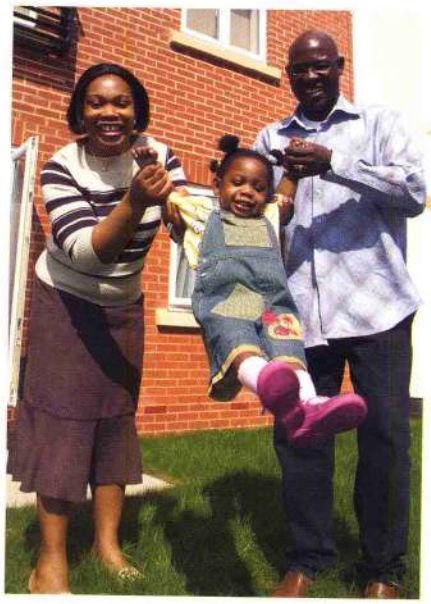
Tavy Bridge currently has 326 homes, 12 shops, an unused community centre, a library and a health centre. The new plans build on key features of the area such as the lake, public transport and the health centre. Homes will be rebuilt and refurbished, with improved community facilities, better lake views and more open spaces.

Energy saving features and security controlled block access will be built into 827 new homes. Of these, 555 will be sold on the open market to subsidise the homes set aside for rent and shared ownership. The scheme will be completed over nine years with a six-phase construction programme due to start in Autumn 2004. Each phase will take around 18 months, with the first phase including the demolition of the deck, construction of a new health centre and the internal refurbishment of 96 occupied homes.

Gallions' schemes prioritise first time buyers, key workers and existing local authority or housing association tenants



modern living



Gallions move into shared ownership, combining a mortgage and rent, is attracting more first time buyers and key workers to Thamesmead.

"I had attempted to buy a property through another housing association. It was very complicated and I could never speak to anyone who knew what they were talking about. In the end I applied to Gallions. Their staff were brilliant, they knew what they were talking about, and they explained each step of the process very well. I moved in three months after sending in the application. We love the space and light of our new home and our daughter Ese has a lovely garden to play in. Buying this apartment is the best thing to happen to us."

Henry Eferemo, a Mental Health Nurse at the Maudsley Hospital, talks about his new home at Priory Place.

Shared ownership – part rent, part buy

It's been a busy and exciting time for the Gallions Affordable Home Ownership Team. Set up in October 2003, the team has sold 72 new homes through affordable home ownership schemes to people who can't buy a home outright. In most shared ownership schemes the buyer typically pays 50% of the cost of a property with a mortgage and pays the rest in rent until they can afford full ownership. Gallions' schemes prioritise first time buyers, key workers and existing local authority or housing association tenants.

Gallions sold 22 homes to local people through our shared ownership schemes this year.

Key worker equity loan scheme

This Government-funded scheme works by offering a loan of up to £50,000 to key workers to purchase a home. The buyers make no payments on the loan and are only required to repay it when they sell their property. The amount borrowed is calculated as a percentage of the property's market value at the time of purchase and the repayments are based on the property's value at the time of sale.

Gallions sold 50 homes to key workers through the Government key worker equity loan scheme this year.

Our purchasers: 2003/4 averages

- *72% of homes were sold to key workers*
- *65% of homes were sold to the BME community*
- *19% of purchasers released a local authority or housing association home for re-let*
- *Our new homes were sold to purchasers with an average annual household income of £22,000*
- *The average sales period for Gallions schemes was 10 weeks, exceeding all set targets. Priory Place, had an outstanding two week sales period.*

NATIONAL HOUSING FEDERATION

Achievement in Diversity Award 2004

Awarded by the National Housing Federation for Gallions' Affordable Home Ownership Scheme at Priory Place. The award recognised Gallions' efforts in ensuring a mixed tenure that reflected Thamesmead's varied cultures.

At Gallions, we always listen to our customers. We provide a number of ways in which residents can tell us what they think and we tailor our services to meet their needs



putting the customer first



"The contractor was quick, polite and did not even stop for a cup of tea! Their work was carried out the day after I made the call. Thank you one and all for a very good response and excellent work done."

Customer questionnaire feedback, 2004

Summary

Building Services and the Customer Response/Service Centres raised 18,568 maintenance jobs over the year in response to customers' needs.

- *Based on 4,500 properties, this means there were more than four repairs per property*
- *4,316 jobs were emergencies, 6,027 jobs were urgent and 8,225 were routine*
- *Axis' average job cost for the year was £109.00*
- *We pre-inspected 1,325 jobs and post inspected 2,760 jobs*
- *We sent out 14,808 customer satisfaction forms and received 4,051 back, an average response of 27.4%*
- *Nearly 97% of customers were satisfied with the contractors' performance and 92% with the service overall. Our target was 90%!*
- *Our surveys show that our tenants are satisfied with our service*
- *Repair costs for 2003/4 totalled £2,411,269.*

Day to day

These sorts of comments are becoming commonplace where Gallions' maintenance and repair work is concerned. 2003/4 has been a challenging year during which we have achieved the majority of our objectives with our maintenance contractor, Axis Europe. We pledged to achieve the following targets with Axis for day-to-day repairs:

- *Attend to emergency repairs 95% on time: We achieved 99%*
- *Attend to urgent repairs 90% on time: We achieved 98%*
- *Attend to routine repairs 90% on time: We achieved 90%.*

We therefore achieved 97.67% of repairs within the times we said we would!

Voids (empty properties), planned and cyclical maintenance

We used 2003/4 to review the condition of our stock, and had many of our homes inspected using Gallions' surveyors. The surveys focused on meeting the Decent Homes Standard set by the Government, the new minimum standard that all social housing must meet by 2010. Completion of the stock survey allowed our Building Services Team to plan long-term maintenance for the immediate seven and next 30 years. We investigated 366 voids in 2003/4, 94% of which were rented out again within 3.5 weeks.

While the stock condition survey was carried out, a number of re-roofing (Buckwheat Court), window replacement (Thamesmead West) and external redecoration projects (Parkway, Southmere and Lesnes) were carried out. We also finalised asbestos surveys and are now fully compliant with Government regulations.

Other contracts

Last year we successfully appointed consultants Otis to install lifts, and Cartel for Door Entry/CCTV, both for five-year periods. We are now developing partnership arrangements with these companies similar to our agreement with Axis. We are pleased that the Gallions Residents' Board were involved in both appointments.

Customer Response Centre

The Customer Response Centre (CRC) is a one-stop shop where customers can receive services by telephone or email. Our Response Centre staff are certainly quick on the draw. Recent figures for January, February and March 2004, showed that 76% of all resident phone calls were answered within 15 seconds. During the year the CRC received 94,504 calls and successfully answered 77,337 of them, an answer rate of 81.8%. These are great improvements in terms of performance and quality of service.

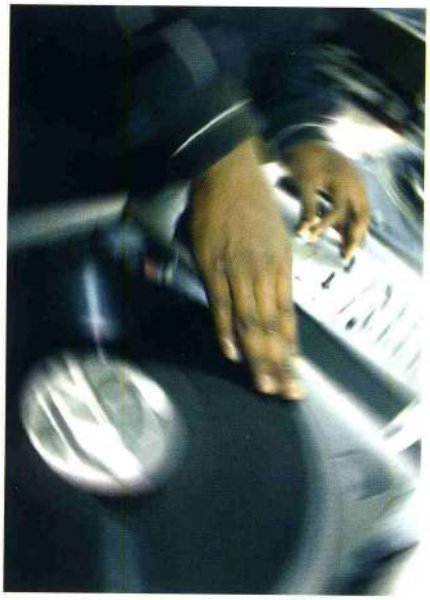
Customer Service Centre

The Customer Service Centre (CSC) has progressively become more popular with Gallions' customers. It boasts an all inclusive service whereby customers can go in and book repairs, check rent accounts, collect keys and fobs, scan documents and raise general housing matters with staff directly. The centre has discussion rooms for confidential matters, access to translation services for non-English speaking people, a hearing loop system and internet access facilities. In addition to these features, useful leaflets, journals and daily newspapers are always on display. We have also provided a baby changing room and a play area to keep children occupied while their parents talk with staff.



The views of the panel have helped change and shape many important issues over the year

a community voice



Listening to the community is important to us. By speaking to our tenants, we're giving the Thamesmead community a strong voice that helps us move in the right direction.

Giving tenants a say:

The GRB

The Gallions Residents' Board (GRB) is always consulted over important policies and procedures. They're an invaluable source of ideas and opinions and the best route to the tenants and customers who matter most to us.

Over the year, the GRB was consulted on a number of issues that had an impact on residents including lift maintenance, entry phone systems, the lettings policy, the updated GHA Business Plan, temporary re-housing policy and equality.

We are also happy to say the GRB was involved in the following:

- *Working with Tilfen Land to improve their community consultation*
- *Continuing to work with Gallions and maintenance contractor Axis, through monthly reviews of the service*
- *Working with Gallions and Axis to introduce a leaseholders' repairs service*
- *Continually reviewing members' training needs. This year they asked Priority Estates Projects (PEP) to provide training to enable them to start monitoring services provided to residents. These courses covered issues including mediation and training skills. Eight tenants also attended the TPAS annual conference and voted at the TPAS AGM*
- *The Tenants' Resource Centre continued to expand*
- *Two GRB members were appointed to the Operations and Development Committee in addition to four Gallions' Board members*
- *The fourth annual 'Housing Fayre' was held in August, themed 'Living Together in Thamesmead'. As well as being a family fun-day, the event allowed members of all Gallions' teams to talk to residents*
- *Sponsorship continued for Thamesmead's Under-11s football team*
- *Introducing neighbourhood forums in April 2003, with six held throughout 2003/4 addressing local issues.*

Equality and Diversity:

The work of EaDiP

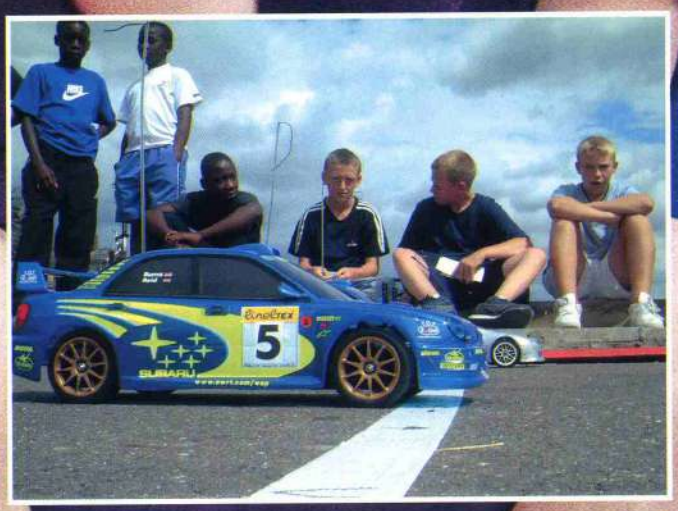
Gallions' Equality and Diversity Panel is now a well-established part of Gallions, with its ideas and opinions running through all our work. The panel comprises staff, board members, residents and community groups, whose purpose is to represent the views of residents on equality and diversity issues.

When EaDiP began, it worked solely with black, minority and ethnic residents, but over the last year its work has expanded to include other issues such as disabilities.

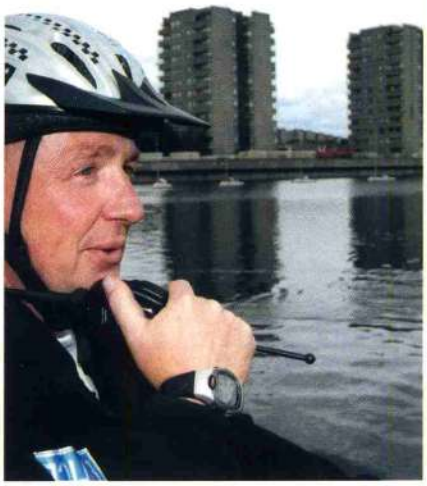
The views of the panel have helped change and shape many important issues over the year, such as:

- *Developing the ideas behind 'Living Together' (Gallions' Equality and Diversity strategy)*
- *Establishing a support network for victims of racial incidents*
- *Introducing a dedicated staff member experienced to deal with racial matters.*

developing strong communities means far more than just building new homes



the business of neighbourhoods



Our Community Investment Team continues to develop strategies that make Thamesmead a safe place where people enjoy living and working.

We realised early on that developing strong communities means far more than just building new homes. It is through our community projects that our commitment to the National Housing Federation's iN Business' really shines through. We have developed a strong working relationship with local police and have become actively involved in crime prevention by introducing our own neighbourhood warden scheme.

Wardens on the beat

Our neighbourhood wardens continue to go from strength to strength. They are now established as one of the most active schemes in the country and regularly encourage exchange visits from wardens working at other RSLs to improve relevant services up and down the country. Over the year they have developed a network of good contacts in Thamesmead whom they regularly visit to ensure good community feedback. They have also worked closely with the police to target crime hotspots and anti-social behaviour.

Managed by a Gallions appointed project manager, the wardens comprise both Gallions and Greenwich Council staff. Their work is overseen by a committee whose membership includes Greenwich Council, the Metropolitan Police and Gallions. We are happy to say that the scheme has undergone expansion this year and now covers Bexley as well as Greenwich.

This year the wardens placed particular emphasis on helping young and elderly members of the community by setting up the following projects:

- *A remote control car club (received an Innovation award from the ODPM)*
- *A computer games club*
- *A football club.*

These ongoing projects are all aimed at providing alternative activities for young people, in some cases providing a diversion from crime and anti-social behaviour. The wardens also established a system of weekly visits to older and more vulnerable residents.

Investing in the community

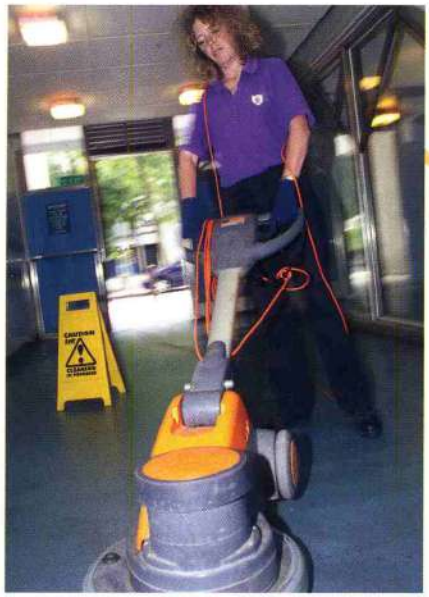
Our Community Investment Team was established in 2001, and has since developed a community strategy to ensure that Thamesmead is a place where people enjoy living and working. Their wide-ranging strategy continued to expand this year and included the following:

- After-school clubs: *in partnership with local schools and Trust Thamesmead, these clubs were developed to provide better opportunities and support for local young people*
- Cross-borough policing: *Bexley Police officers are now based at Gallions, with their own office in the heart of the housing management team. Bexley and Greenwich officers are working closer together to form a strong foundation for policing the whole Thamesmead neighbourhood*
- Police bicycles: *the Community Investment Team contributed bikes and cycle equipment allowing police officers to cover a broader area of Thamesmead*
- Police motorbikes: *these Gallions funded motorbikes continue to be a success in reducing vehicle and road crime*
- Anti-Social Behaviour Orders: *the Investment Team obtained its first ASBO. This was used as a last resort and has removed a serious problem that had blighted the lives of residents for many years*
- School Work: *working with schools and bus companies to address after school disruptive behaviour, particularly on public transport.*

With the help of Team Gallions, tenants are becoming more deeply involved in keeping Thamesmead tidy



cleaning up!



Team Gallions is now well established as the main provider of environmental services across Thamesmead. This year the team has made great strides in developing a professional and highly valued service.

A seamless service!

Last year the team introduced a new fleet of vehicles and equipment to Thamesmead that included tippers for bulk rubbish removal, ride-on machines and a sophisticated Schmidt road sweeping machine. These services continue to expand, with a new two-monthly 'rubbish amnesty' where our staff take away rubbish brought to them. Deep cleaning of the larger blocks in Thamesmead also continues. Last summer, the team completed the stripping and polishing of all landings in the tower blocks and lift lobbies throughout Thamesmead – nearly 300 floors in all!

Working with the community

With the help of Team Gallions, tenants are becoming more involved in keeping Thamesmead tidy. This year, the team encouraged elderly residents to brighten up their communal homes, by providing them with pots and window-boxes for bedding. Young volunteers from the Prince's Trust were also encouraged to successfully plant 2,000 bulbs and 120 shrubs with Team Gallions in communal gardens. At the same time, unemployed members of the community were given valuable work experience. Bromley Field Studies Centre regularly placed volunteers or trainees with Team Gallions, three of whom went on to become full-time employees. Last years Thamesmead in Bloom garden competition also allowed members of Team Gallions to meet residents from 116 households.

Additional hours

In response to residents, Team Gallions allocated additional staff-hours for the removal of rubbish from the waterways in Thamesmead. After a lengthy wait for planning permission, comprehensive work has been carried out on the protected trees east of Maran Way, including selective pruning or removal to improve the quality of the landscape. New trees and plants were also planted.

Meeting the public

Talking to residents is important to Team Gallions. A colourful stand at the Housing Fayre this year, highlighting the different aspects of Team Gallions' work, was followed by a leaflet and poster campaign aimed at changing the behaviour of some residents when disposing of waste. A regular Team Gallions column in the local newspaper, the *Thamesmead People*, also provides tenants with valuable information and is complemented by activities in schools aimed at reaching families through their children. This public contact was supported by a weekly daytime surgery that allowed management staff to meet residents.

Chase the Waste!

Team Gallions receives many survey forms each month which show that rubbish in the canals, dog mess and litter are important issues with residents. To help solve these problems, the Team launched 'Chase the Waste', an environmental campaign explaining how tenants should dispose of their rubbish. In May, five tons of rubbish was put on vans by the public in response to 'Chase the Waste' literature.

Staff training and recruitment

Team Gallions continues to grow with experienced and hard working staff. A new full-time member of staff was employed solely to deal with the removal of abandoned and untaxed vehicles, with 336 vehicles dealt with in the first eight months! A memorable year was capped with a range of staff training programmes that culminated in all staff achieving the nationally recognised British Institute of Cleaning Science certificate at bronze level. The progression to silver is now underway. To make the delivery of training more cost effective and flexible, the team also started 'trainer training' in selected skills, facilitating the delivery of in-house training as required.

Gallions' Ecopark continues to lead the way as a model of excellence in affordable, environmentally friendly housing



homes of tomorrow



In its second year, interest in Ecopark continued to grow with many people eager to learn how this method of affordable and practical housing can be adopted in mainstream construction.

Ecopark Awards 2003/4

- Gold Award – Best Energy Saving Development: *Daily Telegraph 'What House?' Awards*
- Top 20 short-listed development: *Sunday Telegraph 'Carbon Trust' Awards*
- Commendation Award: *Civic Trust Awards*
- Top 25 short-listed entries: *St Andrew's International Prize for the Environment*
- Sustainability Standard Award: *Sustainable New Homes Awards*

What it's like to live at Ecopark

On December 6th 2002, Annette Stowe, her husband and three daughters moved into one of the newly completed three bedroom homes in Gallions Ecopark. Eighteen months later, she shares her thoughts on these environmentally friendly houses.

The Stowe family moved in just before Christmas, from a two-bedroom house in Plumstead. Before their move Annette and her husband carried out some research on the Ecopark development and were excited about what they saw.

> "When I saw that some of the houses had something called a sunspace I really hoped I would get one of those properties – they just looked so nice. When I realised I got a house with one I was so excited. I love it, it's absolutely brilliant. In the summer it's the place to be and in the winter you can still sit out there."

Of the 39 homes within Ecopark, 22 of the properties have sunspaces – 9 of which are three-bedroom houses and 13 two-bedroom. Sunspaces are a full-height, conservatory style feature, in which residents are able to open the doors and windows into the space allowing the trapped heat to flow through, warming the rest of the house. Sunspaces work best in spring and autumn when there are sunny days that are still cool and normally require the use of central heating.

A common concern associated with living in environmentally friendly housing is the amount of training and technology that many view as standard with this type of housing. From the outset, one of our key objectives for Ecopark was to provide user-friendly housing, properties which would not only make a real environmental saving but also reduce residents' energy and water consumption levels.

> "We were not worried about any changes or things we'd have to learn about in order to live here, we were looking forward to it. But to be honest, even though we thought the development would be different somehow, it's not. Apart from looking a bit different and the obvious saving on bills, it's just a normal house."

As part of the monitoring campaign being conducted to evaluate the scientific and practical success of the project, more than 50% of our Ecopark residents have been interviewed to find out what they think of the houses. The feedback will provide valuable input to our design brief ensuring that we continue to incorporate the features that make the most positive impact on the environment for our future tenants.

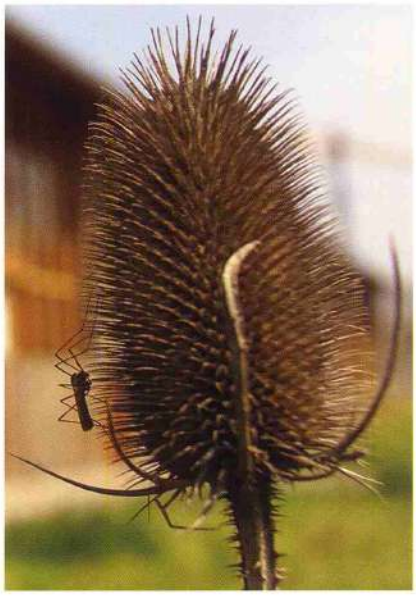
Feedback from residents has shown that Ecopark has been a resounding success. A formal report analysing and reviewing the feedback residents have presented will be available from our website at **www.gallionsecopark.co.uk**

> "I don't really think I can stress how happy we are living here. I just love my house, I can't wait to show it off. I tell everyone that I live in a state-of-the-art house and they should come and have a look. The fact that Gallions is planning to build more houses like this is just great – this should be how houses are built," says Annette.





performance indicators 2003/4



The following report provides an analysis base m

Housing stock

During the year 115 new properties made up of 93 houses for rent and 22 shared ownership houses were completed.

The rented homes consisted of 29 two-bed flats (4 for disabled), 16 two-bed houses (1 for disabled), 44 three-bed houses (3 for disabled) and 4 four-bed houses. The shared ownership units were all two-bed flats.

During the same period 43 homes were sold under RTB giving a net gain in the housing stock (rented) of 50 units resulting in a total rented stock of 4,586 units.

The stock can be broken down by number of bedrooms as follows:

Table 1
Stock/number of bedrooms

Rents

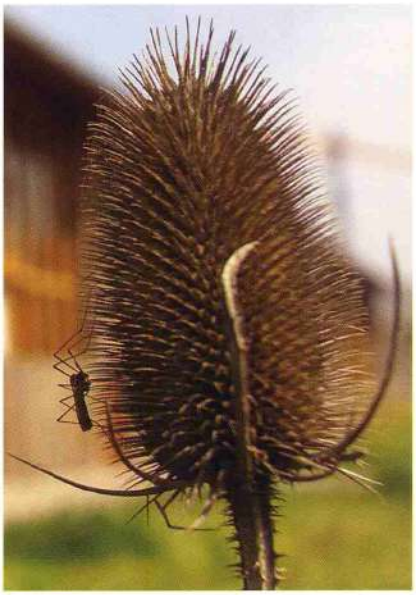
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However, Gallions received dispensation from the Housing Corporation in respect of secure rents, which can now be increased over and above the annual RPI guidance check up to the latest registered rent values subject to this not exceeding target rents.

Based on the above, secure rents were increased in April 2003 by an overall weighted average of £4.46 per week, or 8.11%.

For Housing Corporation purposes target rents and rent comparisons are based on net rents exclusive of service charges. The following table sets out GHA 2003/4 weighted average rents compared to the respective weighted target rents.

performance indicators 2003/4



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	41%	24%	23%	12%

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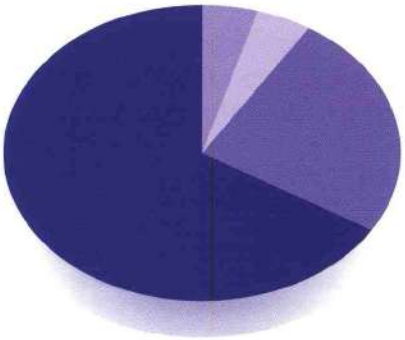
	SECURE	ASSURED	TARGET
Bedsit	£49.83	£60.99	£48.88
One bed	£51.40	£66.45	£53.96
Two bed	£59.77	£72.66	£72.72
Three bed	£68.52	£88.43	£75.11
Four bed	£74.05	£97.66	£77.87
Overall average	£63.08	£74.11	£66.16

The overall average rents have increased over last year by 7.72% for secure, 0.82% for assured and 12.25% for target rents.

The above table illustrates the differences between average secure and assured rent levels and the limitations in respect of future rent increases. The average target rent for two-bed properties has increased significantly this year due to the number of new builds. If these were to be discounted the average target rent (which would apply to original stock) is more in the region of £65.

Pie chart 1

Actions taken against rent arrears



Confirmed	4,513	4.5%
Overridden	4,459	4.5%
Disregarded	24,603	24.7%
Ignored	66,088	66.3%

Rent Roll

The rent roll for the year after adjustments was £18,156,060 an increase of £789,441 compared to 2002/3.

This increase can be attributed to the increase in secure rents and the additional income for new builds, both from 2002/3 and 2003/4.

The following table breaks down and compares the component parts of the rent roll.

Table 3
Rent Roll

	2002/3 £	2003/4 £	DIFFERENCE £	%
Rent	15,473,972	16,245,353	771,381	4.99
Service charges	1,483,382	1,442,583	(40,799)	(2.75)
Fuel charges	4,602	2,293	(2,309)	(50.17)
Garage/alarms	356,209	419,967	63,758	17.90
Management	8,725	8,725	100	
Adjustments	47,454	39,390	(8,064)	(16.99)
	17,365,619	18,156,060	790,441	4.55

The small reduction in service charge income can be attributed to the completion of Comfort 2000. This project replaced the district heating system with 4,500 new individual gas central heating systems. Similarly this brought an end to fuel charges except for Sanderling Court where communal heating is provided, which necessitates associated service and fuel charges. Preparation for 'Supporting People', which commenced in April 2004, saw an increase in community alarm charges. The management income was in respect of short stay tenancies granted to LB Bexley.

At year end 63% of tenancies were assured (61% in 2002/3) and accounted for nearly 70% of rental income with the remaining 37% of tenancies being secure and accounting for 30% of income.

The number of terminated secure tenancies in the year after allowing for Right to Buy (RTB) sales was 72 compared to 65 and 84 in the previous two years. Given the generally low secure rent levels, reduced RTB discounts and subsequent applications it is unlikely that there will be any significant increase in tenancy migration.

Bearing in mind current rent levels, especially assured rents, rent increase restrictions from rent restructuring and the slow down in tenancy migration, rental income growth will be increasingly dependent upon growth in the housing stock.

Rent collection

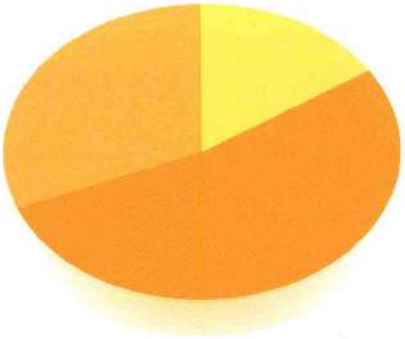
Receipts for the year after adjustments, but excluding write offs, amounted to £17,831,512, which gives a collection rate of 98.21% compared to 98.8% last year.

For Housing Corporation indicators the rental income used to calculate rent collection rates should include former tenant arrears brought forward from the previous year. After taking these figures into account the collection rates are 93.13% and 93.49% respectively.

The method of paying rent shows very little variance compared to last year as illustrated by table 4. The only exception has been the introduction this year of direct debits, which has accounted for 1.33% of payments received.

Pie chart 2

Waiting lists



75	External applicants	16%
145	Thamesmead residents	31%
252	Internal transfers	53%

The number of applicants on the waiting list at year-end was 472 compared to 447 last year.

Table 4
Methods of rent payment

	2003/4 £	2003/4 PCT%	2002/3 PCT%
Housing Benefit	9,338,361	51.92	51.2
Bank	1,807,971	10.05	11.27
Post Counter cheques	0	0	0.04
Miscellaneous	5,053	0.03	0.02
Amenity Direct	4,265	0.02	0.01
Swipe Cards	6,265,573	34.83	35.40
Direct Debit	238,849	1.33	0
GIRO	45,307	0.25	0.43
Payment at Gallions	263,202	1.46	1.51
RTB Balances	6,918	0.04	0.03
Westminster CC	11,700	0.07	0.10

Rent arrears

As suggested in the report for 2002/3 the way in which rent arrears is reported has changed and is now shown for the weeks in which the bulk of housing benefit is received in order to reflect a more accurate reflection of arrears.

Performance throughout the year saw arrears at below the target rate of 4.5% in nine of the 13 four week periods and an overall average of 4.49%.

The average rent arrear per tenancy of £320 showed a significant improvement over last year's average of £351.

The average number of tenants in arrears (55.37%) also fell compared to last year (58%), attributable to the change in reporting.

The improvement in arrears is due to the sustained actions in rent recovery procedures and the issuing of notices at an early stage signalling the company's serious intent of pursuing and recovering rent arrears. This is noticeable by referring to the following table showing the monthly average number of arrears cases by value bands.

Table 5
Rent arrears by value bands

	2003/4	2002/3	DIFFERENCE	
£ VALUE BAND	NUM	NUM	NUM	PCT%
£500 - 1,000	259	290	31	10.7
£1,000 - 2,000	139	161	22	13.7
£2,000 - 3,000	27	38	11	28.2
£3,000 - 4,000	7	6	(1)	(16.7)
£4,000 - 5,000	2	2	0	0
	434	497	63	12.7

Recovery actions

During the year the computerised rent arrears system generated 99,000 rent arrear action recommendations, an increase of 28,000 (39%) compared to last year.

A recommendation can be confirmed (accepted), overridden (a different action is taken), disregarded (the recommendation is not considered appropriate), or ignored (in system terms no action taken).

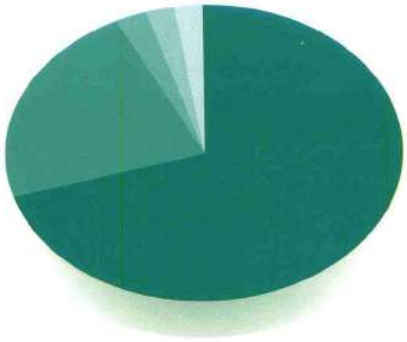
Of the generated recommendations the actions taken are shown in pie chart 1.

The high number of 'ignored' recommendations should be viewed with some caution. Depending upon the value of the arrear and previous action the system will generate a recommendation every week, or at periods determined by the type of action required. In many cases a recommendation will be made only days after an action has been processed and it is ignored as insufficient time has elapsed for the tenant to respond.

Out of the 8,972 (6,013 last year) actions taken 651 (706) consisted of notices seeking possession of which 46 (107) resulted in suspended possession orders,

Pie chart 3

Letting breakdown



	NUM	PCT
HOMES Nominations	9	1.95%
Short Stay	8	1.74%
Applicants	8	1.74%
Transfers /exchanges	78	16.92%
LA Nominations	247	53.58%
Thamesmead Resident	111	
	461	

seven (29) suspended evictions (stays) and 54 (55) evictions. The remainder either resulted in settlement of arrears, an arrangement to pay, or are still subject to Court proceedings. During the year 42 (117) tenants agreed to an arrangement plan to clear their arrears. The above figures show a significant reduction in legal proceedings compared to last year, which is borne out by the earlier table showing reductions in arrears by value bands and the importance of chasing rent arrears at an early stage.

The number of evictions at 54 was one less than last year, but significantly the average eviction debt fell from £2,960 last year to £2,846 a reduction of £114, or 3.8%. This follows on from last year's improvement of £423, or 12.5%.

Empty properties (voids)

Month end voids

Discounting new builds the average number of month end voids was 44 compared to 39 last year.

However, this years figures include 16 units at Sanderling Court, which were occupied last year, but which have been withdrawn for letting this year. If the Sanderling Court units are discounted the averages become 35 for both years. In terms of available voids as percent stock this years average is 0.60% compared to 0.77% last year.

New voids

Excluding new builds (93) there were 337 new voids in the year compared to 391 last year a reduction of 54 properties, or 14%.

The breakdown of this year's voids (excluding new builds) by property type shows a significant percentage increase for one-bed units, but varying reductions for other sized properties.

Table 6
Void property breakdown

	BEDROOMS							
	ONE		TWO		THREE		FOUR +	
TYPE	NO	PCT %	NO	PCT %	NO	PCT %	NO	PCT %
Bedsits	17	5.04						
Sheltered bedsits	13	3.86						
Sheltered flats	4	1.19						
Flats	86	25.52	68	20.18	3	0.89		
OPDs	84	24.93						
Houses			3	0.89	14	4.15	8	2.37
Maisonettes			3	0.89	20	5.93	14	4.15
	204	60.53	74	21.96	37	10.98	22	6.53
2002/03	219	56.01	88	22.51	55	14.07	29	7.42

Void re-let periods

The overall re-let period for the year was 4.13 weeks compared to the target of 4 weeks and last years 3.88 weeks. This figure can be further analysed into 2.42 weeks for new builds and 4.60 weeks for original stock.

Waiting lists

The number of applicants on the waiting list at year end was 472, compared to 447 last year, as shown in pie chart 2.

Lettings

During the year there were 461 new lettings, which can be analysed, as shown in pie chart 3.

There were 41 lettings fewer than last year, which can be attributed to a similar fall in the number of new voids for the period.



Repairs completion

Repair completion performance continued to improve compared to last year and exceeded target in all repair categories.

Table 9
Reactive repairs

	EMERGENCY	URGENT	ROUTINE	OVERALL
Reactive Repairs				
Target	95%	90%	90%	90%
Actual	99%	98%	96%	97%
2002/03 Target	96%	96%	96%	96%
2002/03 Actual	98%	95%	95%	96%

Void Repairs	
Target	99%
Actual	94%
2002/03	96%

Equal opportunities

For performance monitoring purposes equal opportunities has been limited to re-housing and evictions.

Measuring performance of these areas against the ethnic make up of tenants is limited due to the availability of data.

The most recent tenancy audit provides us with much missing data for 75% of current tenants.

Based on the total number of current tenants 23.5% can be identified as a BME group.

The breakdown of current tenants into ethnic groups is as follows.

Table 10
tenant breakdown by ethnicity

ETHNICITY	BME	NUM	PCT
African	Y	541	11.81%
African Caribbean	Y	48	1.05%
Asian	Y	27	0.59%
Asian – British Bangladesh	Y	4	0.09%
Asian – British Indian	Y	15	0.33%
Asian – British Pakistani	Y	2	0.04%
Black – British African	Y	95	2.07%
Black – British Caribbean	Y	33	0.72%
Black – British other	Y	7	0.15%
Chinese	Y	29	0.63%
EEC		4	0.09%
European		66	1.44%
Mixed – Other	Y	12	0.26%
Mixed – W/B African	Y	7	0.15%
Mixed – W/B Caribbean	Y	16	0.35%
Mixed – White Asian	Y	5	0.11%
Other		106	2.31%
Refused to state		8	0.17%
UK Black	Y	190	4.15%
Unknown		1162	22.28%
Vietnamese	Y	36	0.79%
White – British		2113	46.12%
White – Irish		43	0.94%
White – Other		13	0.28%
		1,077	4,582
			23.5%

performance indicators 2003/4



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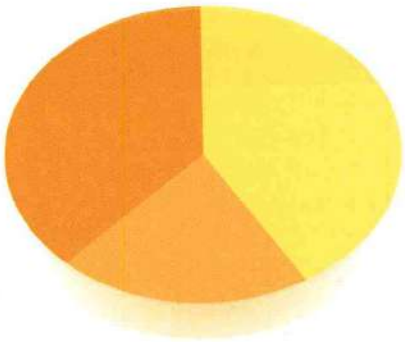
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Two bed	£59.77	£72.66	£72.72
Three bed	£68.52	£88.43	£75.11
Four bed	£74.05	£97.66	£77.87
Overall average	£63.08	£74.11	£66.16

The overall average rents have increased over last year by 7.72% for secure, 0.82% for assured and 12.25% for target rents.

The above table illustrates the differences between average secure and assured rent levels and the limitations in respect of future rent increases. The average target rent for two-bed properties has increased significantly this year due to the number of new builds. If these were to be discounted the average target rent (which would apply to original stock) is more in the region of £65.

board information

Board representation



Residents	86%
Local authority	43%
Independents	78%



Gallions Board as at 31 March 2004

Residents

Tokky Ademoyero
Graham Horton
Freda McEwen
Ken Sealey

Local Authority Nominees

Manny Blake
Peter Challis

Independent Board Members

Ronke Adeagbo
Aman Dalvi
Peter Dean
Chris Garlick
Keith Wrate

Gallions Board

Board and committee structure

During the year the association undertook a major revision of its structure and governing rules, reducing the number of Board members from 15 to 12, as recommended by the Housing Corporation and National Housing Federation. Following a recruitment exercise an independent Board member and an independent Chair were recruited to strengthen the Board.

The Board operates a governance structure of four committees. Each committee's brief is to scrutinise in detail the policy and performance issues within its scope. Committee members with the appropriate skills and experience are drawn from the Board and co-opted members with particular knowledge and skills strengthen each committee. The structure of the committees is shown in the chart below left.

To secure wider engagement of Board members, a system of Board 'champions' for particular subjects or areas and one-off short-lived working groups for particular subjects is operated. These include:

- *Equality and diversity*
- *Development*
- *Public relations*
- *Probity*
- *Health and safety*

Obligations of board members

A Board member's obligations include:

- *upholding the association's core policies, including those for equal opportunities*
- *upholding the values and objectives of the association*
- *contributing to a shared responsibility for the Board's decisions*
- *preparing for and attending meetings, training and other events of the association*
- *representing the association on occasions*
- *declaring any relevant interests*
- *respecting confidentiality of information*
- *upholding the National Housing Federation's Code of Governance.*

No individual can stand for, or remain a member of the association or Board if they have arrears or any other dispute with the association, unless they have entered into a satisfactory arrangement for clearing those arrears or resolving the dispute.

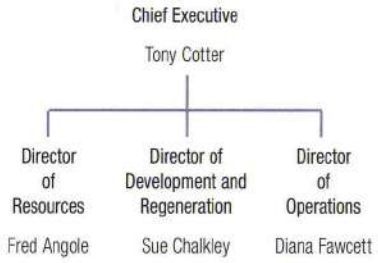
Skills, qualities and experience required of Board members

It is of key importance that the Board ensures that its members have the skills, knowledge and experience to enable them to carry out their responsibilities effectively. The recruitment, induction and training of Board members are crucial elements to ensure the sound governance of the association.

The Board will ensure that new members are recruited or elected on a systematic and continuous basis and, wherever possible, by open advertisement or by consultation with other interested bodies. Members recruited should have relevant skills and experience and the Board as a whole will seek to reflect the communities within which it works.

The Board considers the balance of skills and experience that is appropriate to its work and recruits members openly and systematically to achieve this balance. At least once each year the Board identifies any skills required amongst its membership to satisfactorily discharge its responsibilities.

Executive Team



Board member knowledge and experience

	levels of knowledge and experience		
	Little %	General %	High %
The housing needs that the RSL aims to meet	-	64	36
Residents' needs and concerns	-	45	55
Strategic management in a public or private body	9	36	55
General business activities including the management of staff, property and contracts	-	18	82
Finance	9	64	27
Legal matters	27	64	9
Community relations and needs, including equal opportunities	-	55	45
Working with local authorities	9	18	73
Development and building	27	45	27
Public relations	9	64	27
Management of information technology	36	45	18
Race equality	-	55	45

The table above shows the skills, qualities and experience that Board members are required to have and the extent to which they are met by members currently in office and those retiring who intend to re-offer themselves for election. Both the Housing Corporation and the Charities Commission lay down these criteria and Gallions must comply with these legal requirements:

Method of election for tenant and charge-payer Board members

Resident Board members are drawn from members of Gallions Residents' Board who have been elected by the tenants/charge-payers of the association respectively and are proposed for consideration to the Board by the executive of the GRB.

Any candidate for election to the Board is required to submit a written statement to the association setting out the reasons for their suitability to be a Board member.

Shareholding membership policy

Gallions is committed to maintaining a broadly based shareholding membership as a means of ensuring openness and accountability and to encourage greater resident involvement in the management of their homes.

All applications for membership of the Association should meet at least one of the following criteria:

- *the applicant has a long-term interest in and support for the association*
- *the applicant has the appropriate skills, experience and availability to make a significant contribution to the association by becoming a member, either at the time of application or in the future*
- *the applicant has the commitment and relevant skills and/or experience to make a positive contribution to the Association without becoming an active member*
- *the applicant will help to improve the representation of local communities within the association's shareholding*
- *the applicant will contribute to achieving a balanced mix within the Association's shareholding.*

Regulatory compliance

Gallions complies with the National Housing Federation's 2004 Code of Governance 'Competence and Accountability' and is fully compliant with the Housing Corporation Regulatory Code.

income and expenditure account

for the year ended 31 March 2004

	Group		Association	
	2004	2003	2004	2003
	£	£	£	£
Turnover				
Group and share of joint venture	38,131	34,799	26,960	19,803
Less: Share of joint venture turnover – Tilfen	(11,171)	(14,996)	-	-
Group turnover	26,960	19,803	26,960	19,803
Operating costs	(18,051)	(18,486)	(18,051)	(18,486)
Cost of sales	(6,734)	-	(6,734)	-
Operating surplus	2,175	1,317	2,175	1,317
Share of operating surplus in joint venture	4,470	7,027	-	-
Total operating surplus including share of joint venture	6,645	8,344	2,175	1,317
Surplus on sale of fixed assets	1,797	1,309	1,797	1,309
Surplus on ordinary activities before interest	8,442	9,653	3,972	2,626
Interest receivable	261	229	39	97
Interest payable	(853)	(804)	(667)	(733)
Surplus on ordinary activities before taxation	7,850	9,078	3,344	1,990
Taxation (charge)/credit on surplus on ordinary activities	(528)	67	3	-
Retained surplus for the year	7,322	9,145	3,347	1,990

The operating surplus for the year arises from continuing operations of the Group and Association.

balance sheet

as at March 2003/4

	Group		Association	
	2004	2003	2004	2003
	£	£	£	£
Fixed assets				
Housing properties	116,022	98,695	116,022	98,695
Less: Social housing grant	(6,584)	-	(6,584)	-
Depreciation	(5,763)	(4,191)	(5,763)	(4,191)
	103,675	94,504	103,675	94,504
Other tangible assets	3,071	3,481	3,071	3,481
Investments in subsidiaries and joint venture	-	-	20,439	20,439
Investments in joint venture				
Share of gross assets	57,860	47,412	-	-
Share of gross liabilities	(12,748)	(8,888)	-	-
Investments in starter homes initiative	335	-	335	-
	152,193	136,509	127,520	118,424
Current assets				
Work in progress	922	-	922	-
Debtors	2,424	1,929	2,424	1,929
Cash at bank and in hand	7,269	1	7,269	1
	10,615	1,930	10,615	1,930
Creditors: amounts falling due within one year	(11,214)	(4,717)	(11,179)	(4,683)
Net current liabilities	(599)	(2,787)	(564)	(2,753)
Total assets less current liabilities	151,594	133,722	126,956	115,671
Creditors: amounts falling due after more than one year	21,749	13,600	21,749	13,600
Provision for liabilities and charges	1,598	1,809	1,598	1,809
Capital and reserves				
Share capital	-	-	-	-
Revenue reserves	34,329	25,473	15,732	10,851
Revaluation reserve	6,041	3,429	-	-
Negative goodwill	87,877	89,411	87,877	89,411
	151,594	133,722	126,956	115,671

Approved by the Management Board on 21 September 2004.